

Duncan Webb

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Nova School of Business and Economics
Department of Economics
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Research Fields

Primary: Development Economics; **Secondary:** Behavioural Economics

Positions

Nova School of Business and Economics, Lisbon <i>Assistant Professor of Economics</i>	2025 —
Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) <i>Affiliate</i>	2026 —
Princeton University <i>Postdoctoral Scholar in Economics</i>	2024-2025
Paris School of Economics (PSE) <i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>	2019-2024 Supervisors: Karen Macours, Suanna Oh
Massachusetts Institute of Technology <i>Visiting Scholar in Economics</i>	2022-2023 Sponsors: Esther Duflo, Frank Schilbach
University of California, Berkeley <i>Visiting Scholar in Economics</i>	2021 Sponsor: Supreet Kaur
Paris School of Economics (PSE) (summa cum laude) <i>Masters in Economics: Public Policy and Development</i>	2017-2019
Oxford University (1st class) <i>BA Philosophy, Politics and Economics</i>	2012-2015

Working Papers

Silence to Solidarity: How Communication About A Minority Affects Discrimination [[PDF](#)]
Conditionally Accepted, Journal of Political Economy
Winner of Weiss Family NEUDC Distinguished Paper 2023

Menstrual Stigma, Hygiene, and Human Capital: Experimental Evidence from Madagascar [[PDF](#)]
with *Karen Macours and Julieta Vera Rueda*

Psychological Mechanisms for Measuring Preferences and Beliefs [[PDF](#)]
with *Evan Friedman and Suanna Oh*

Publications

Critical Periods in Cognitive and Socioemotional Development: Evidence from Weather Shocks in Indonesia [[PDF](#)]
The Economic Journal, 2024

COVID-19 spread, detection, and dynamics in Bogota, Colombia [\[PDF\]](#)

Nature Communications, 2021

with Rachid Laajaj et al

Understanding how socioeconomic inequalities drive inequalities in COVID-19 infections [\[PDF\]](#)

Scientific Reports, 2022

with Rachid Laajaj, et al

Selected Works in Progress

Teaching Teenagers Healthy Smartphone Habits: Evidence from Colombia

with Janet Currie, Oscar Díaz, Juan Saavedra, & Frank Schilbach

Hygiene, Learning, and Biomarkers of Stress: Experimental Evidence from Madagascar

with Karen Macours, Oscar Díaz, and Mariachiara Iannuzzi

How Persistent Are the Impacts of Global Education and Health Interventions?

with Eva Vivalt

Using AI to Improve Health Care in India

with Patrick Agte and Pascaline Dupas

Using AI to Evaluate the Robustness of Research in Economics

Rethinking Restrictive Masculinity Norms: Economic Disaffection and Young Men's Wellbeing in India

with Seema Jayachandran

Professional service

Referee for: *Quarterly Journal of Economics; American Economic Review: Insights; Journal of Political Economy: Micro; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; World Development; Journal of Health Economics; Economics of Education Review*

Employment

Teaching Fellow, Econometrics (Graduate)	PSE, 2020-21
World Bank, Consultant to DIME	2018
Cancer Research UK – Digital Innovation Manager	2015-2017

External presentations

2025: UC Berkeley, Duke, UCSD

2024: Harvard Economics Development Seminar, NBER Summer Institute, RookieFest (Northwestern University), LSE Inclusion Workshop, World Bank Gender Innovation Lab, CEPR Development Economics Symposium, CSAE, AEA LGBTQ+ Economics, PSE Scientific Council, EAYE-AM

2023: OxDEV, Advances with Field Experiments, NEUDC, CEPR Policy Forum, MIT Behavioural Lunch, MIT Development Lunch, International Conference on Development Economics (AFEDEV)

2022: Berkeley Development Seminar, MIT Behavioural Lunch, MIT Development Lunch

Grants, Awards, Fellowships

FID (Funds for Innovation in Development), Stage 3 (w. Karen Macours & Oscar Díaz)	2026
Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant	2026
Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant (w. Arkadev Ghosh)	2026
Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant (w. Nina Buchmann, Leticia Juarez & Sakib Mahmood)	2026
CGI Medium Grant (w. Seema Jayachandran)	2026
CGI Medium Grant (w. Patrick Agte & Pascaline Dupas)	2026
JPAL Learning for All Initiative (w. Janet Currie, Oscar Díaz, Juan Saavedra & Frank Schilbach)	2026
GEM Incubation Fund	2025
Google.org, AI and health	2025
JPAL Innovation in Governance Initiative	2025
French Association of Economic Sciences (AFSE) – Best PhD Prize Special Mention	2025
JPAL Learning for All Initiative	2025
Open Philanthropy Research Grant	2025
FID (Funds for Innovation in Development) (w. Karen Macours & Oscar Díaz)	2024
Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant	2023
Institute for Humane Studies, Conference Accelerator Grant	2023
JPAL Crime and Violence Initiative, Research Grant	2022
Global Priorities Fellowship, Forethought Foundation	2022-2023
SurveyCTO Data Collection Research Grant	2022
Research Grant, EUR-PGSE	2022
Research Grant, CEPREMAP	2022
Grant, FID (Funds for Innovation in Development) (w. Karen Macours & Julieta Vera)	2021
JPAL Post-Primary Education Initiative (with Karen Macours and Julieta Vera)	2021
Research Grant, CEPREMAP	2021
Research Grant, EUR-PGSE (with Suanna Oh and Evan Friedman)	2021
Research Grant, CEPREMAP (with Karen Macours and Julieta Vera)	2021
Ecole Doctorale 465 Full Funding	2019-2022
PhD Scholarship (2 highest performing students in Masters)	2018
Eiffel Excellence Scholarship	2017-2019
Exhibition Scholarship, BA in Philosophy, Politics, Economics	2015

Skills and Interests

Languages: English (native), French (fluent), Spanish (beginner)

Software: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, SurveyCTO, oTree

Other interests: jazz music, meditation, Effective Altruism

References

Professor Karen Macours
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Professor Suanna Oh

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Professor Frank Schilbach

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Professor Abhijit Banerjee

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